elections; and, by avoiding the occupation of the enclave, maintaining public support for Israel and the US. Quite a full plate. We will know more tomorrow.

The chief of Military Intelligence today took full personal responsibility for the lack of vital information ahead of Hamas's attack. Netanyahu and Gallant, the two main culprits, still refuse to accept any culpability. When shall we get rid of these two?

The normalization of relations between Israel and Saudi Arabia may have incited Iran's conflict escalation in the hopes of destroying what Tehran views as a threat to its role in the Muslim world. It certainly succeeded in putting all efforts of normalization on hold. No one seems to know how things may ultimately play out. It reminds me of a sentence in *The Complete War Memoirs of Charles de Gaulle*: "Vers l'Orient compliqué, je m'envolais avec des idées simples." (Toward the complicated East, I flew with simple ideas.) Today, the East is by far more complex than it was in 1941.

Prime Minister Olaf Scholz of Germany arrived in Israel to display his country's solidarity. So did the Romanian prime minister, and the president of the EU, Ursula von der Leyen. British PM Rishi Sunak is expected in the coming days. Each visit is welcome, but the atmosphere in the country is out of control: no one dares tone down the thirst for revenge that has spread; it may compel the leadership to take political and military missteps. No moderate opinion dares express itself locally regarding the conflict. Today, prominent right-wing television presenter Ayala Hasson threatened *Haaretz*, Israel's only liberal daily, with retribution for its typical anti-Netanyahu stance. *O tempora, o mores* … The Israel that will emerge from this war will not be the country that we have known and which found its most recent expression in the vast demonstrations against the policies of Netanyahu's coalition. The war, despite the widespread anger generated by the country's dismal unpreparedness, may be a boon for ultranationalists.